extant book on algebra is by the famous astronomer, Aryabhata, who was born in **A.C**. 476. He wrote this book on astronomy and mathematics when he was only twenty-three years old. Arya-bhata, who is sometimes called the inventor of algebra, must have relied, partly at least, on the work of his predecessors. The next great name in Indian mathematics is that of Bhaskara I (**A.C**. 522), and he was followd by Brahmagupta (**A.C**. 628), who was also a famous astronomer, and who stated the laws applying to *shunya* or zero and made other notable advances. There follow a succes-sion of mathematicians who have written on arithmetic or algebra. The last great name is that of Bhaskara II, who was born in **A.C.** 1114. He wrote three books, on astronomy, algebra, and arithmetic. His book on arithmetic is known as 'Lilavati', which is an odd name for a treatise on mathematics, as it is the name of a woman. There are frequent references in the book to a young girl who is addressed as 'O Lilavati' and is then instructed on the problems



stated. It is believed, without any definite proof, that Lilavati was Bhaskara's daughter. The style of the book is clear and simple and suitable for young persons to understand. The book is still